

- **Is the character centred to the origin?**

Make sure to set your model around the centre of origin. It helps you to understand and animate the character quickly.

Types of joints

For animated characters, there are three types of joints which will be a guide, to begin with, your character movement in the film.

- **Joint through overlapping circles**

With overlapping circles, you can animate rotation on the pivots. In this way, the joints never break. It is the most universal and widely used joint by animators and filmmakers. It doesn't require any specific attention or touch up.

One drawback is that it is clearly visible and doesn't look stylish.

- **Overlapping circles at limb surface**

Overlapping circles that are present only in a part of the limb surface gives an organic look to the character.

The drawback, in this case, is such joints have lesser flexibility, and the elements need different elements inside the containers to make it look natural from different angles.

- **Angular joint**

These joints are not created with circles. The two elements of the character meet and make up a joint. When you style it, it gives a fantastic appeal to your character.

One disadvantage of this joint is it needs various states of elements to put inside the container. The limbs might appear shorter when they bend, so you have to do some correction of length and other small touch-ups.

All these joints can be used together in the same character.

Creating the character

After you get a fair idea of what kind of joints are used in character, you can get started with the creation of your character.

You have to sketch your character first and then mark the joints and its types. You can draw the joints in the form of circles as later they will be converted in Graphic Symbols.